

# Trump pursues deals as he visits Mideast

President wants Saudi Arabia, Qatar and the United Arab Emirates to commit to investing billions in the U.S.

By NABIH BULOS AND MICHAEL WILNER

RIYADH, Saudi Arabia — The first time President Trump visited Riyadh in 2017, he posed with a ceremonial orb, took part in a traditional sword dance and secured an agreement by Saudi Arabia to purchase \$350 billion in weaponry, the largest arms deal in U.S. history.

The sequel, coming eight years later — almost to the day — promises much the same in the way of pageantry and purchases, only more so. Even before the trip, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman vowed he would invest about \$600 billion over the four years of Trump's presidency ('Trump asked him to round it up to \$1 trillion).

And although the orb will probably not make an appearance this time around, Trump is bringing with him a phalanx of business leaders for a Saudi-U.S. business summit Tuesday — the day he arrives — that will include BlackRock Chief Executive Larry Fink, OpenAI's Sam Altman, Palantir Technologies' Alex Karp, Tesla's Elon Musk and Meta's Mark [See Mideast, A4]

# Probe of false evacuation alerts lists some causes

Congressman seeks regulation after report details L.A.-area fire response problems.

By JENNY JARVIE

After conducting an investigation into Los Angeles County's faulty emergency alerts during the deadly January wildfires, U.S. Rep. Robert Garcia (D-Long Beach) issued a report Monday calling for more federal oversight of the nation's patchwork, privatized emergency alert system.

The investigation was launched by Garcia and more than a dozen members of L.A.'s congressional delegation in February after L.A. County sent a series of faulty



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

## NEWSOM CALLS FOR CAMPING CRACKDOWN

California's governor plans to escalate the state's push to eradicate homeless encampments, calling on local governments to ban tent camps on sidewalks and other public property. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

# White House is investigating state's benefits for immigrants

Critics dispute its claims, deny federal aid goes to noncitizens

By JENNY JARVIE

The Trump administration announced Monday that it has launched an investigation into California's Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants, which provides monthly cash benefits to a small number of aged, blind or disabled noncitizens who it claims are ineli-

gible for Social Security benefits due to their immigration status.

The investigation began in Los Angeles, with the local field office of Immigration and Customs Enforcement's Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants, which provides monthly cash benefits to a small number of aged, blind or disabled noncitizens who it claims are ineli-

According to the department, the subpoena requests all records from the Los Angeles County Department of Public Social Services, which administers the state program, to determine whether ineligible immigrants received Supplemental Security Income from the Social Security Administration over the last four years. "Radical left politicians

in California prioritize illegal aliens over our own citizens, including by giving illegal aliens access to cash benefits," Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem said in a statement.

"The Trump Administration is working together to identify abuse and exploitation of public benefits and make sure those in this [See Benefits, A6]



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

**MIKE PINGEL** of West Hollywood gets an eye scan from World, a service from Tools for Humanity that scans irises to distinguish between humans and robots.

# Eye-scanning orbs are sparking curiosity and fear in California

A device touted as a tool to identify humans raises concerns over breach and misuse of biometric data

By QUEENIE WONG

SAN FRANCISCO — This month, a mysterious store selling a vision of the future opened its doors in downtown San Francisco's Union Square district.

A cryptic message appeared on the storefront window: "World is the real human network. Anonymous proof of human and universally inclusive finance for the age of AI. Millions of humans in over 160 countries. Now available in the USA."

The store attracted a small crowd and curious onlookers. People took turns scanning their eyes by peering into white devices known as orbs — to prove they are human. Then they received, free of charge, a verified

World ID they could use to log in to online services and apps. As a bonus, participants were given some Worldcoin cryptocurrency tokens.

Some just observed from a distance. "I'm afraid to walk inside," said Brian Klein, 66, as he peered into the window on his way to the theater. "I don't want that thing taking any of my data and biometric scanning me."

The futuristic technology is the creation of a startup called Tools for Humanity, which is based in San Francisco and Munich, Germany. Founded in 2019 by Alex Blania and [See Scans, A9]

# U.S. AND CHINA REACH TRADE TRUCE

Temporary deal buoys investors but may not save consumers from shortages, price hikes in the near future.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — China and the United States re-treated from an emerging economic crisis on Monday, agreeing to drastically reduce tariffs on each other for the next 90 days as they continue to negotiate a more permanent trade deal, providing welcome news for investors and retailers who increasingly feared a breakthrough was out of reach.

The temporary truce will see the United States lower tariffs on Chinese imports to 30% from 145%, and China reduce its import duties on U.S. goods to 10% from 125%, starting Wednesday. Wall Street rejoiced at the announcement of a deal, with the Dow Jones industrial average up 2.81%, the Standard & Poor's 500 up 3.26%, and the Nasdaq up 4.35%, the largest market rally since President Trump last walked back rate hikes on other countries in mid-April.

Trump referred to the development as a "total reset with China." But the end result of the provisional agreement is a return to tariff rates that were in place before the president launched a global trade war on April 2, in what he called "Liberation Day" — a move that brought the largest decline in commercial shipping traffic since the COVID-19 pandemic and prompted financial institutions to warn of an imminent recession.

Supply shortages and price increases on Chinese products may still hit American consumers in the coming weeks, a lingering effect of weeks of uncertainty, experts said. Many retailers have already increased their prices. And shipping costs are expected to skyrocket as manufacturers and whole- [See Tariffs, A6]

## Trump proposes drug prices cut

Executive order sets a deadline for manufacturers to lower the cost of medications in the U.S. **NATION, A5**

## Sean Combs' trial underway

Music mogul's lawyers concede he has a violent temper but say he committed no federal crimes. **NATION, A7**

## Freeman's hot bat 'relentless'

With his swing finally in sync, the first baseman has gone on a tear at the plate for the Dodgers. **SPORTS, B10**

## Weather

Mostly cloudy. L.A. Basin: 71/54. **B6**

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